“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Ādi-līlā

Chapter 3

The Auspicious Invocation of Blessing: The General Cause of Caitanya’s Descent

(English translation from the Bengali, following the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition and the Anubhāṣya, 2026)

1 I bow to the Lord Śrī Caitanya. Through the power of taking shelter at His feet, even an ignorant man gathers the precious jewels of conclusive truth (*siddhānta*) from the many mines of scripture.

2 Glory, glory to Śrī Caitanya! Glory to Nityānanda! Glory to Advaitacandra! Glory to all the devotees of Gaura!

3 I have explained the meaning of the third verse. Now, O devotees, hear the meaning of the fourth.

4 “May the Lord Hari, the son of Śacī, illumined by a mass of lustre more beautiful than gold, ever shine in the inmost cave of your hearts. Out of His mercy He has descended in the age of Kali to bestow what had not been given for a very long time — the treasure of devotion to Himself, rich in the most exalted, radiant *ujjvala-rasa*.” (Vidagdha-mādhava, 1.2)[1]

5 Kṛṣṇa, the son of the king of Vraja, is Bhagavān in all His fullness. Together with all Vraja He enjoys His pastimes eternally in Goloka.

6 Once in a day of Brahmā He descends and displays those pastimes in this world.[2]

7 The four ages are Satya, Tretā, Dvāpara and Kali, and together they make up one divine age (*divya-yuga*).

8 Seventy-one such cycles make one manvantara, the reign of a Manu, and fourteen manvantaras make up a day of Brahmā.[3]

9 The present, seventh manvantara is called Vaivasvata, and twenty-seven of its cycles have already passed.

10 At the end of the Dvāpara of the twenty-eighth cycle, Kṛṣṇa appears in this world together with His Vraja.[4]

11 Servitude, friendship, parental affection and the love of the beloved (*śṛṅgāra*) are the four rasas, and Kṛṣṇa is under the sway of all the devotees who have these four moods.[5]

12 With His servants and friends, His father and mother and His beloved ones, Kṛṣṇa sports in Vraja, absorbed in love.

13 Having sported as He wished, Kṛṣṇa disappears, and afterwards He reflects:

14 "For a long time I have not given the gift of loving devotion (*prema-bhakti*), and without devotion the world has no ground to stand on.

15 All over the world they worship Me by the rules of scripture (*vidhi-bhakti*), but devotion by rule has no power to reach the love of Vraja.

16 The whole world is permeated by the awareness of My majesty, and love slackened by awe gives Me no joy.[6]

17 Worshipping by rule in the awareness of My majesty, they go to Vaikuṇṭha and attain the four kinds of liberation.

18 These are *sārṣṭi* (opulence equal to Mine), *sārūpya* (a form like Mine), *sāmīpya* (nearness to Me) and *sālokya* (residence in My world). But *sāyujya*, in which one becomes one with Brahman, the devotee never accepts.[7]

19 I shall inaugurate the religion of the age, the congregational chanting of the holy name (*nāma-saṅkīrtana*), and, giving devotion in the four moods, I shall make the whole world dance.

20 I shall take on the mood of a devotee, and by practising devotion Myself I shall teach it to all.

21 Unless one practises dharma oneself, one cannot teach it. This is the conclusion sung in the *Gītā* and the *Bhāgavatam*.

22 “Whenever, O descendant of Bharata, dharma declines and irreligion rises, then I manifest Myself.” (Bhagavad-gītā, 4.7)

23 “To deliver the saints, to destroy the wicked and to establish dharma, I appear in age after age.” (Bhagavad-gītā, 4.8)[8]

24 “If I did not act, these worlds would perish; I would be the cause of confusion among the classes of men and would ruin all these beings.” (Bhagavad-gītā, 3.24)[9]

25 “Whatever the best of men does, others do the same; whatever standard he sets, the world follows.” (Bhagavad-gītā, 3.21)

26 The religion of the age can be established by My portion (*aṁśa*), but none but Me can give the love of Vraja.[10]

27 “Let there be many all-auspicious avatāras of the Lord whose navel is a lotus; but who other than Kṛṣṇa gives prema even to the creepers?” (Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta, 1.5.37)[11]

28 Therefore, taking My own devotees with Me, I shall descend to earth and enjoy many kinds of pastimes.”

29 Thinking thus, Kṛṣṇa Himself descended in Nadīyā in the first junction (*sandhyā*) of the age of Kali.[12]

30 So the lion Caitanya appeared in Navadvīpa — with the neck of a lion, the strength of a lion and the roar of a lion.

31 May that lion take His seat in the cave of every soul’s heart — the lion at whose roar the elephant of sin perishes.

32 In His early pastimes His name was Viśvambhara. He filled the world with the nectar of devotion and upheld all living beings.

33 The root *ḍubhṛñ* means “to nourish and to sustain”: giving love, He nourished and sustained the three worlds.

34 In His later pastimes He bears the name Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya. Making Śrī Kṛṣṇa known to all, He blessed the whole world.[13]

35 Knowing Him to be the avatāra of the age, the great Garga declared it at Kṛṣṇa's name-giving ceremony.

36 "Your son, who accepts a body in every age, has appeared in three colours — white, red and yellow; now He has become dark (*kṛṣṇa*)." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.8.13)[14]

37 White, red and yellow — these three lustres the Lord of Śrī assumes in the Satya, Tretā and Kali ages.

38 Now, in Dvāpara, He has become dark. This is the essence of all the scriptures — the Āgamas and the Purāṇas.

39 "In Dvāpara the Lord is dark, clad in yellow and bearing His own weapons, and He is known by the Śrīvatsa and other marks and characteristics." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 11.5.27)

40 In the age of Kali the religion of the age is the spreading of the holy name. For this the golden-hued avatāra, Caitanya, has come.[15]

41 His lustre is like molten gold, His body tall and mighty, and His deep voice surpasses the thunder of fresh rain-clouds.

42 One whose height and arm-span both measure four of his own cubits is famed as a *mahāpuruṣa*, a great person.

43 Such a person is called *nyagrodha-parimaṇḍala*, and Caitanya, the abode of all virtues, has such a body.[16]

44 His arms reach down to His knees, His eyes are like lotuses, His nose is finer than a sesame flower, and His face is like the moon.

45 He is peaceful and self-controlled, wholly given to devotion to Kṛṣṇa. He loves His devotees, is gentle by nature and looks on all beings with an equal eye.

46 Adorned with sandal paste and wearing armlets and bracelets of sandal-wood, He dances in the saṅkīrtana of Kṛṣṇa's names.

47 Drawing on all these qualities, the sage Vaiśampāyana included His names in the *Thousand Names* of Viṣṇu.[17]

48 Caitanya's pastimes are of two parts, the early and the later, and in each of them He has four special names.[18]

49 "He is of golden colour, His limbs are like gold, His form is beautiful, and He wears armlets of sandal. He has taken sannyāsa, He is self-restrained and tranquil, and His highest refuge is steadfastness and peace." (Mahābhārata, Dāna-dharma, 149; Viṣṇu-sahasra-nāma, 92 and 75)[19]

50 The *Bhāgavatam* makes it clear again and again: in the age of Kali the congregational chanting of Kṛṣṇa's name is the essence of all.

51 "With sacrifices in which congregational chanting predominates, the wise worship the Lord who ever sings of Kṛṣṇa and whose lustre is not dark. He is always surrounded by His intimate companions (*aṅga*), His devotees (*upāṅga*), His weapons and His associates (*pārṣada*)." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 11.5.32)[20]

52 Hear, brothers, of all this glory of Caitanya: this verse speaks of the very height of His greatness.

53 The two syllables 'Kṛṣ-ṇa' are always in His mouth; or else, in His own joy He describes Kṛṣṇa.

54 Thus the two meanings of the word *kṛṣṇa-varṇa* are established: nothing but Kṛṣṇa ever comes to His lips.

55 And if anyone should say that He is dark in colour, the next adjective rules this out.

56 By the lustre of His body He is not dark; and by the words "not dark" the verse tells of His yellow colour.[21]

57 "May that Lord who has appeared in the form of Caitanya be ever merciful to us! In the age of Kali the learned openly worship Him with sacrifices of loud congregational chanting. He is Kṛṣṇa, yet from the abundance of His lustre His body is not dark, and they declare Him the object of worship for all who have entered the fourth āśrama." (Stava-mālā, Second Caitanyāṣṭaka, 1)[22]

58 His lustre of molten gold is plain to see, and its radiance dispels all the darkness of ignorance.

59 To destroy the darkness of the living beings' sins, He bears many weapons — His intimate companions (*aṅga*), His devotees (*upāṅga*) and the holy name.

60 Any action opposed to devotion, be it righteous or unrighteous, is called 'sin' (*kalmaṣa*). That is the great darkness.

61 Raising His arms and calling "Hari!", He casts His loving glance on all; He destroys their sins and floods them with love.

62 "His smiling glance wholly takes away the sorrow of the worlds; His very first words make a whole row of blessings burst into leaf; and what flood of love does the touch of His feet not bring? May that Lord who has

appeared in the form of Caitanya be ever merciful to us!" (Stava-mālā, Second Caitanyāṣṭaka, 8)

63 Whoever sees His beautiful form and face is freed from sin and attains the treasure of love.

64 In other avatāras the Lord came with armies and weapons, but the army of Caitanya-Kṛṣṇa is His intimate companions and devotees (*aṅga* and *upāṅga*).

65 "He is ever worshipped by the gods headed by Śiva and Brahmā, who, full of love for Him, have taken human bodies; and He teaches His own devotees the pure way of worshipping Him. Will that beautiful Caitanya come once again before my eyes?" (Stava-mālā, First Caitanyāṣṭaka, 1)[23]

66 These weapons, His intimate companions and devotees, accomplish His work. Now hear with attention another meaning of the word *aṅga*.

67 The evidence of scripture says that the word *aṅga* means a portion (*aṁśa*), and a part of that portion is called *upāṅga*.

68 "Are You not Nārāyaṇa? For You are the Self of all embodied beings, O Lord, and the witness of all the worlds. Nārāyaṇa is Your portion — so called because His abode is the waters born of Nara; and that too is true, not Your māyā." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.14.14)[24]

69 The Nārāyaṇa who lies on the waters and dwells within every heart is Your portion (*aṁśa*); You are the original Nārāyaṇa.[25]

70 By the word *aṅga* the portions (*aṁśa*) are meant, and They are real. They are not a product of māyā: all of Them are full of consciousness and bliss.[26]

71 Advaita and Nityānanda are the two *aṅgas* of Caitanya, and the parts of these *aṅgas* I call *upāṅgas*.

72 These *aṅgas* and *upāṅgas*, ever with the Lord, are His sharp weapons for crushing the unbelievers.[27]

73 Nityānanda Gosāñi is Haladhara Himself, the bearer of the plough, and Advaita Ācārya Gosāñi is the Lord (*Īśvara*) Himself.[28]

74 Taking with them the army of associates headed by Śrīvāsa, the two generals go everywhere performing kīrtana.

75 Nityānanda Rāya bears the banner of the crusher of unbelievers, and at the roar of the Ācārya sins and unbelievers flee.[29]

76 Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya is the founder of saṅkīrtana, and blessed is he who worships Him by the sacrifice of saṅkīrtana.

77 He alone is truly intelligent; the rest of the world is foolish. Of all sacrifices the sacrifice of Kṛṣṇa's name is the essence.

78 Whoever says that ten million horse sacrifices (*aśvamedha*) equal one name of Kṛṣṇa is an unbeliever, and Yama punishes him.[30]

79 Śrī Jīva Gosāñi has explained this verse of the *Bhāgavatam* (3.51) in the auspicious invocation of his book *Bhāgavata-sandarbha*.[31]

80 "Inwardly He is Kṛṣṇa, outwardly He is golden, and He has displayed the splendour of His *aṅgas* and other associates. In this age of Kali, through saṅkīrtana and the other limbs of devotion, we have taken shelter of Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya." (Tattva-sandarbha, 2)[32]

81 In the Upapurāṇas too we hear the words of Śrī Kṛṣṇa, which He mercifully spoke to Vyāsa:

82 “O brāhmaṇa, at some time in the age of Kali I Myself shall take the order of sannyāsa and lead people stricken by sin to devotion to Hari.” (Upapurāṇa)[33]

83 The *Bhāgavatam*, the *Mahābhārata*, the Āgamas and the Purāṇas give clear proof of the descent of Caitanya-Kṛṣṇa.[34]

84 See for yourselves His many manifest powers — His wondrous deeds and the extraordinary signs of His love.

85 Yet the non-devotees see without seeing, as the owl does not see the rays of the sun.[35]

86 “Though You are made known by Your supremely excellent nature, forms and deeds, by Your wondrous power and purity, by the mighty scriptures and by the teachings of the renowned knowers of the divine Truth, those of demonic nature can never understand You.” (Stotra-ratna, 15)[36]

87 Kṛṣṇa tries in many ways to hide Himself, yet His devotee knows Him.

88 “Your sovereign nature transcends the three kinds of limits and admits of no equal or superior. Though You hide it by the power of Your māyā, some who are devoted to You alone see it constantly.” (Stotra-ratna, 18)[37]

89 Those of demonic nature never know Kṛṣṇa, but from His devotees He cannot hide.

90 “In this world there are two kinds of created beings, the divine and the demonic. The devotee of Viṣṇu is called divine, and his opposite demonic.”

(Padma Purāṇa)[38]

91 Ācārya Gosāñi is the Lord's avatāra as a devotee, and His roar was the cause of Kṛṣṇa's descent.

92 When Kṛṣṇa descends to earth, He first causes His elders to appear.

93 Father, mother, guru and all who are to be honoured — He first has them all take birth on earth.

94 Mādhavendra Purī, Īśvara Purī, Śacī and Jagannātha appeared, and Advaita Ācārya appeared along with them.

95 Having appeared, the Ācārya saw the whole world busy with worldly affairs, without even a trace of devotion to Kṛṣṇa.

96 Some through sin, some through piety, all were enjoying the objects of the senses; there was not even a scent of the devotion that cures the disease of worldly existence.

97 Seeing the state of the people, the compassionate Ācārya pondered how they might be helped.

98 He thought: "If Śrī Kṛṣṇa Himself were to descend, He would practise devotion Himself and so spread it.

99 In the age of Kali there is no religion but the holy name. Yet how will Kṛṣṇa descend in the age of Kali?

100 With a pure heart I shall worship Kṛṣṇa, and with humility I shall pray to Him unceasingly.

101 Only when I have brought Kṛṣṇa here and spread His kīrtana will My name ‘Advaita’ bear fruit.”[39]

102 As He pondered by what worship Kṛṣṇa could be won over, a verse came to His mind.

103 “For merely a leaf of tulasī or a palmful of water, the Lord who loves His devotees sells Himself to them.” (Viṣṇu-dharma; Gautamīya-tantra)[40]

104–105 The Ācārya pondered the meaning of this verse: “Kṛṣṇa is indebted to the person who offers Him tulasī and water. He considers how to repay him, and finds: ‘In all My house there is no wealth equal to water and tulasī.’”[41]

106 So He repays the debt by selling Himself. Thinking thus, the Ācārya began His worship.

107 Meditating on Kṛṣṇa’s lotus feet, He constantly offered Him tulasī buds (*mañjarī*) with the water of the Gaṅgā.

108 With a mighty roar He called out to Kṛṣṇa, and in this way He brought about Kṛṣṇa’s descent.[42]

109 This is the chief cause of Caitanya’s descent: the Lord, the protector of dharma, descends by the desire of His devotee.[43]

110 “O Lord, the path to You is seen through hearing, and You dwell in the lotus of the heart that devotion has purified. O Urugāya, widely sung One, whatever form of Yours Your devotees contemplate, that very form You reveal to them out of mercy.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 3.9.11)[44]

111 The meaning of this verse, in brief, is this: all Kṛṣṇa's descents take place by the desire of His devotees.

112 Thus I have made the meaning of the fourth verse clear: Gaura descended to reveal divine love.[45]

113 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.

Notes

1. The same verse as Ādi 1.4. *Anubhāṣya*: with this verse Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī, blessing the world, opens the drama *Vidagdha-mādhava*, and the author, his follower, follows the guru he holds dear. *Unnatojjvala-rasa* is "the exalted *ujjvala-rasa*, that is, *śṛṅgāra-rasa*"; *sva-bhakti-śrī* is "the beauty of prema for Him"; *sphuratu* — "may He reveal Himself". ↩
2. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: in Goloka, the splendour (*vaibhava*) of Gokula, Kṛṣṇa dwells eternally with everything that makes up the rasa of Vraja; these are His unmanifest (*aprakaṭa*) pastimes. Once in every kalpa, that is, in each day of Brahmā, He descends into the world and displays them as manifest (*prakaṭa*) pastimes. ↩
3. *Anubhāṣya* (after the *Sūrya-siddhānta*): Kali-yuga lasts 432,000 solar years, Dvāpara twice as long, Tretā three times and Satya four times; together they make 4,320,000 years — a *mahā-yuga*, or *divya-yuga*. Seventy-one *mahā-yugas* make a manvantara; fourteen manvantaras, with fifteen junctions (*sandhi*) each as long as a Satya-yuga, make a thousand *yugas* — a day of Brahmā, or kalpa. ↩
4. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «সহিত» (another reading: «সহিতে»). *Anubhāṣya*: when twenty-seven *mahā-yugas* of the Vaivasvata manvantara have passed, in the twenty-eighth, after Satya and Tretā, at the end of Dvāpara, comes the time of Kṛṣṇa's appearance. ↩
5. *Anubhāṣya*: *śānta-rasa* is not named here because, though in the material world it is held highest, in the spiritual world it stands lowest: in it there is no exchange of feeling between Kṛṣṇa and His devotee. In servitude, friendship, parental love and *madhura* the love for Kṛṣṇa rises step by step. *Śṛṅgāra* is

the love of the beloved ones of Vraja, not a conjugal relationship (see Ādi 1.4). ↩

6. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: in *vidhi-bhakti* the awareness of majesty (*aiśvarya*) prevails; in that mood prema slackens and loses its depth, and such love does not please the Lord. ↩
7. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: *sārṣṭi* — opulence equal to Viṣṇu's; *sārūpya* — a form like Viṣṇu's, with four arms and so on; *sāmīpya* — dwelling near Him; *sālokya* — residence in His world. The *Anubhāṣya* refers to the *Bhāgavatam* (3.29.13): "Even when offered *sālokya*, *sārṣṭi*, *sārūpya*, *sāmīpya* and oneness, My people do not accept them without My service." ↩
8. *Anubhāṣya*: the saints (*sādhu*) are those devoted to serving the Lord, and He delivers them from the obstacles to their service; the wicked (*duṣkṛt*) are the enemies of the devotees whom none but He can slay — Rāvaṇa, Kaṁsa, Keśī and others; dharma is non-envious service to Bhagavān, whose chief mark is saṅkīrtana. ↩
9. *Anubhāṣya*: the Lord, free from any desire for worldly enjoyment, acts to set an example: if He did not act, people taking Him as their model would fall; *upahanyām* — "I would ruin", that is, "make them impure". ↩
10. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the Lord wishes to appear in order to bring the world two things — the religion of the age, *nāma-saṅkīrtana*, and the love of Vraja. The religion of the age can be established even by a partial avatāra, but the love of Vraja none can give except the complete Bhagavān, Śrī Kṛṣṇa. ↩
11. In the edition — "the words of Bilvamaṅgala" (*Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta*, Pūrva-khaṇḍa, 5.37). *Anubhāṣya* and *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the "creepers" (*latā*) are those who have taken shelter of Him. ↩
12. *Anubhāṣya*: the first *sandhyā* is the opening period of an age, a twelfth part of it; the first *sandhyā* of Kali-yuga lasts 36,000 solar years. Śrī Gaurasundara appeared when 4,586 years of Kali had passed — that is, in its first *sandhyā* — at Śrī Māyāpur in Navadvīpa. ↩
13. In the edition verses 3.32 and 3.34 are headed: the name Viśvambhara is the presiding Deity of *abhidheya* (the means), the name Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya the presiding Deity of *sambandha* (knowledge of the relationship). *Anubhāṣya*: the later pastimes are the twenty-four years after sannyāsa. Mahāprabhu received the name "Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya" when He took sannyāsa from Keśava Bhāratī; in Śaṅkara's line this is a *brahmacārī* name, and He never called Himself by the sannyāsa title "Bhāratī": in that line the sannyāsa name carries the claim to be God, whereas the *brahmacārī* name breathes service to the guru and is not opposed to bhakti. ↩

14. Garga Muni's words to Nanda Mahārāja. *Anubhāṣya*: *tathā* ("likewise") points to the future: He will be yellow in the first *sandhyā* of the Kali-yuga of the twenty-eighth *mahā-yuga* of the Vaivasvata manvantara. Śrī Jīva Gosvāmī (*Krama-sandarbha*, quoted in the *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya* on 3.51) adds that Śrī Kṛṣṇa is the complete form, in whom all the avatāras are contained. ↩
15. *Anubhāṣya*: Śrī Madhvācārya, in his commentary on the *Muṇḍaka Upaniṣad*, quotes the *Nārāyaṇa-saṁhitā*: "In Dvāpara people worship Viṣṇu by the Pañcarātra, but in Kali the Lord Hari is worshipped by the name alone." The *Kali-santaraṇa Upaniṣad*: "Hare Kṛṣṇa Hare Kṛṣṇa Kṛṣṇa Kṛṣṇa Hare Hare / Hare Rāma Hare Rāma Rāma Rāma Hare Hare — these sixteen names destroy the contamination of Kali; no higher means is seen in all the Vedas." ↩
16. *Anubhāṣya*: *nyagrodha-parimaṇḍala* is one whose height and girth are four of his own cubits — a *mahāpuruṣa*; so too is Viṣṇu called, complete in all four of His forms (*catur-vyūha*), who, surpassing all beings, holds them in check by His māyā. ↩
17. *Anubhāṣya*: the *Thousand Names* is the *Viṣṇu-sahasra-nāma* of the *Mahābhārata*, Dāna-dharma, chapter 149; commentaries on it were written by Śaṅkarācārya, Śrī Baladeva Vidyābhūṣaṇa and other Vaiṣṇava ācāryas. ↩
18. *Anubhāṣya*: the early pastimes are His life as a householder, the first twenty-four years; the later are His sannyāsa, the last twenty-four years (cf. 3.32–34). The eight names are given in the next verse. ↩
19. *Anubhāṣya*: the first four names belong to the early pastimes, the last four to the later. According to the *Anubhāṣya* and the commentary *Nāmārtha-sudhā* of Śrī Baladeva Vidyābhūṣaṇa which it quotes: *varāṅga* — a body bearing the marks of a *mahāpuruṣa*; *candanāṅgadī* — wearing sandal armlets that gladden the hearts of the devotees; *śama* — free from worldly attraction (Baladeva: contemplating the secrets of Hari); *śānta* — whose mind is fixed on Kṛṣṇa alone; *niṣṭhā* — steadfastness, one-pointedness of mind (Baladeva: in Him the sacrifice of Hari-kīrtana is established); *śānti* — peace (Baladeva: He subdues the opponents of bhakti, the *kevalādvaitins*); *parāyaṇa* — the highest shelter (Baladeva: of all the moods up to *mahābhāva*). The source is given as in the edition; the second *Sahasra-nāma* verse is 75 (so the edition gives it at Madhya 6.104; here it misprints "95"). ↩
20. *Anubhāṣya*: *kṛṣṇa-varṇam* — "who sings of Kṛṣṇa", or "in whom are the two syllables 'Kṛṣ-ṇa'" (3.53); *tviṣākṛṣṇam* — not dark by lustre, that is, golden: of the white, red and yellow (3.36) the third remains; the *aṅgas* are

Nityānanda and Advaita, the *upāṅgas* Śrīvāsa and the other devotees, the weapons the holy name and the like, the associates Gadādhara, Svarūpa Dāmodara and others; saṅkīrtana is many people singing together the names of Hari and His glories. That He is Kṛṣṇa Himself the author shows below (3.79–80). ↩

21. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «অকৃষ্ণবরণে তাঁর কহে» (in other copies «তাঁর» is missing). ↩
22. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: through the overwhelming lustre of Śrī Rādhikā's heart, Śrī Kṛṣṇa has become not dark but golden; He alone is worshipped by the *paramahaṁsas* — those who have entered the fourth āśrama, sannyāsa. ↩
23. *Anubhāṣya*: the gods headed by Śiva and Brahmā took human bodies to nourish their love for Him; "His own devotees" are Svarūpa, Rāmānanda and His other intimates; the "pure way of worship" is free from other desires and uncovered by karma and jñāna. ↩
24. The same verse as Ādi 2.30 (see the note there on the three meanings of the name Nārāyaṇa). Here the author cites it for the word *aṅgam*, "part": Nārāyaṇa is Your *aṅga*, that is, Your *aṁśa* (3.67, 3.69). ↩
25. In the edition the verse is introduced by the words «অস্যার্থঃ» — "its meaning (of verse 3.68) is this". ↩
26. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: *aṅga* here means the portions (*aṁśa*), the three Puruṣas headed by Kāraṇodakaśāyī; They are full of consciousness and bliss, the true Īśvaras, not anything made by māyā; and so Advaita and Nityānanda are the Lord's two *aṅgas*. *Anubhāṣya*: in the realm of māyā a thing divided by māyā becomes a part; but Viṣṇu-tattva is not subject to māyā, and Viṣṇu, though a portion, is not divided in substance — like a lamp lit from a lamp. All the Viṣṇu forms are masters of māyā, and she has no power over Them; it is otherwise with separated parts such as Brahmā and Śiva, who are capable of transformation, as milk is of turning into curd. ↩
27. *Anubhāṣya*: the unbelievers (*pāṣaṇḍa*) are those who imagine Viṣṇu, the master of māyā, to be equal to Śiva and others who are subject to māyā, and who, not realising the eternity of the Lord's pastimes, take eternal devotion to be mere transient activity; to dispel their folly Viṣṇu and His own people labour. ↩
28. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: that is, Advaita is directly the avatāra of Mahā-Viṣṇu. ↩
29. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: *vānā* — a sign, a banner: an instrument like trumpets and drums by which the crushing of the unbelievers is proclaimed. ↩

30. *Anubhāṣya*: to consider the name equal to pious rites — vows, renunciation, fire sacrifices — is the eighth offence against the holy name, to be avoided in every way. “The gift of ten million cows at an eclipse, a whole kalpa’s dwelling at Prayāga on the Gaṅgā, ten thousand sacrifices, a gift of gold as great as Mount Meru — none of these equals a hundredth part of the glorification of Govinda.” ↩
31. *Anubhāṣya*: the verse “*antaḥ kṛṣṇam…*” (3.80) is the second verse of the invocation of the *Ṣaṭ-sandarbha* (*Bhāgavata-sandarbha*) and is simply an explanation of Karabhājana’s verse (3.51); its meaning is unfolded at the beginning of the *Sarva-saṁvādinī*. ↩
32. *Anubhāṣya*: *antaḥ kṛṣṇam* — within, in His heart, He is Kṛṣṇa, but the mood of His heart, the heart of the Nāgara, is covered by the mood of Rādhā’s heart; *bahir gauram* — outwardly, by the radiance of His body, He is golden; *darśitāṅgādi-vaibhavam* — who has displayed the splendour of His *aṅgas*, *upāṅgas*, weapons and associates. The source is given as in the edition: *Tattva-sandarbha*, the first of the six *Sandarbhas*, verse 2. ↩
33. *Anubhāṣya*: “at some time” (*kvacit*) — in the first *sandhyā* of the Kali-yuga of the twenty-eighth *catur-yuga* of the Vaivasvata manvantara; sannyāsa is the fourth āśrama. ↩
34. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: in the *Bhāgavatam* — “*kṛṣṇa-varṇaṁ tviṣākṛṣṇam*”, “*āsan varṇās trayaḥ*”, “*channaḥ kalau*” (“hidden in Kali”); in the *Mahābhārata* — “*sambhavāmi yuge yuge*”, “*sannyāsa-kṛc chamaḥ śāntaḥ*”; in the Vedas — “*mahān prabhur vai puruṣaḥ*”, “*yadā paśyaḥ paśyate rukma-varṇam*”; in the tantras that follow the Āgamas — “*māyāpure bhaviṣyāmi śacī-sutaḥ*”; in the Upapurāṇa — “*aham eva…*”: thus it is proved that Caitanya-Kṛṣṇa is the direct descent of the Lord. ↩
35. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: *ulūka* — the owl, blind by day; not seeing the sun’s rays, it cannot admit that the sun exists. ↩
36. The source is given as in the edition: Śrī Yāmunācārya’s (Ālavandār’s) *Stotra-ratna*, verse 15. *Anubhāṣya*: Śrī Yāmunācārya is the guru and grand-guru of Śrī Rāmānujācārya; *sattvena* — by extraordinary power, *sāttvikatayā* — by the predominance of pure goodness; those of demonic nature are the ill-natured, hostile to the devotees. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: Vyāsa and other devotees who know the supreme truth come to know You through the powerful scriptures of goodness. ↩
37. The source is given as in the edition: verse 18. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: everything is bound by three limits — place, time and thought — but Your hidden nature, which has no equal or superior, surpasses them; You cover it by

the power of māyā, yet Your exclusive devotees always see You. *Anubhāṣya*: “by the power of māyā” — by the power of His own *yogamāyā*. ↩

38. *Anubhāṣya*: the demonic is one absorbed in the enjoyment of māyā (*māyā-bhoga-niratаḥ*), a man of material nature. ↩
39. In the edition the verse is headed: “Viṣṇu’s descent is brought about through Viṣṇu — hence His name Advaita”: Advaita, Viṣṇu Himself, is non-different from the Lord whom He calls. ↩
40. The source is given as in the edition («বিষ্ণুধর্ম-বচন ও গৌতমীয়-তন্ত্র-বাক্য»). *Anubhāṣya*: “merely a leaf of tulasī” — without sandal paste, mantras and the rest; *vikrīṇīte* (“sells”) — He places Himself under His devotees’ control. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: some copies have here two more verses on the tulasī buds: “As Rādhā is dear to Viṣṇu, so is the *mañjarī* dear to Hari; therefore one should offer it with care, mixed with sandal.” ↩
41. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «এই শ্লোকার্থ» (another reading: «এ শ্লোকার্থ»). In the edition 3.104 and 3.105 are numbered separately. ↩
42. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «কৃষ্ণের» (another reading: «কৃষ্ণেরে»); the sense is the same. ↩
43. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: Kṛṣṇa, the protector (literally “the bridge”, *setu*) of dharma, descends by the desire of His devotee; Caitanya appeared at the prayer of the great devotee Advaita Ācārya. ↩
44. Brahmā’s prayer. *Anubhāṣya*: *śrutekṣita-pathaḥ* — “He whose path is seen through hearing the conclusions of scripture”; *paribhāvita* — the heart made worthy by devotion, by love; *urugāya* — “widely sung”. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: You ever move along the paths of Your devotees’ hearing and sight. ↩
45. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «কৈল» (“I have made”; another reading: «হৈল», “has become”). ↩